

Tuataras live in burrows and hunt at night. They can live for 100 years.



Living fossils

Tuataras are the only survivors of a group of reptiles that lived with the dinosaurs millions of years ago. Today they live on a group of islands off New Zealand.

Scaly skin

A reptile's skin is covered with scales made of keratin, like your nails.



Tortoise: the shell of a tortoise has lots of large, hard scales on it.



Lizard: Lizards' scales have stretchy skin between them.



Crocodile: these scales are strengthened in between by bony plates.



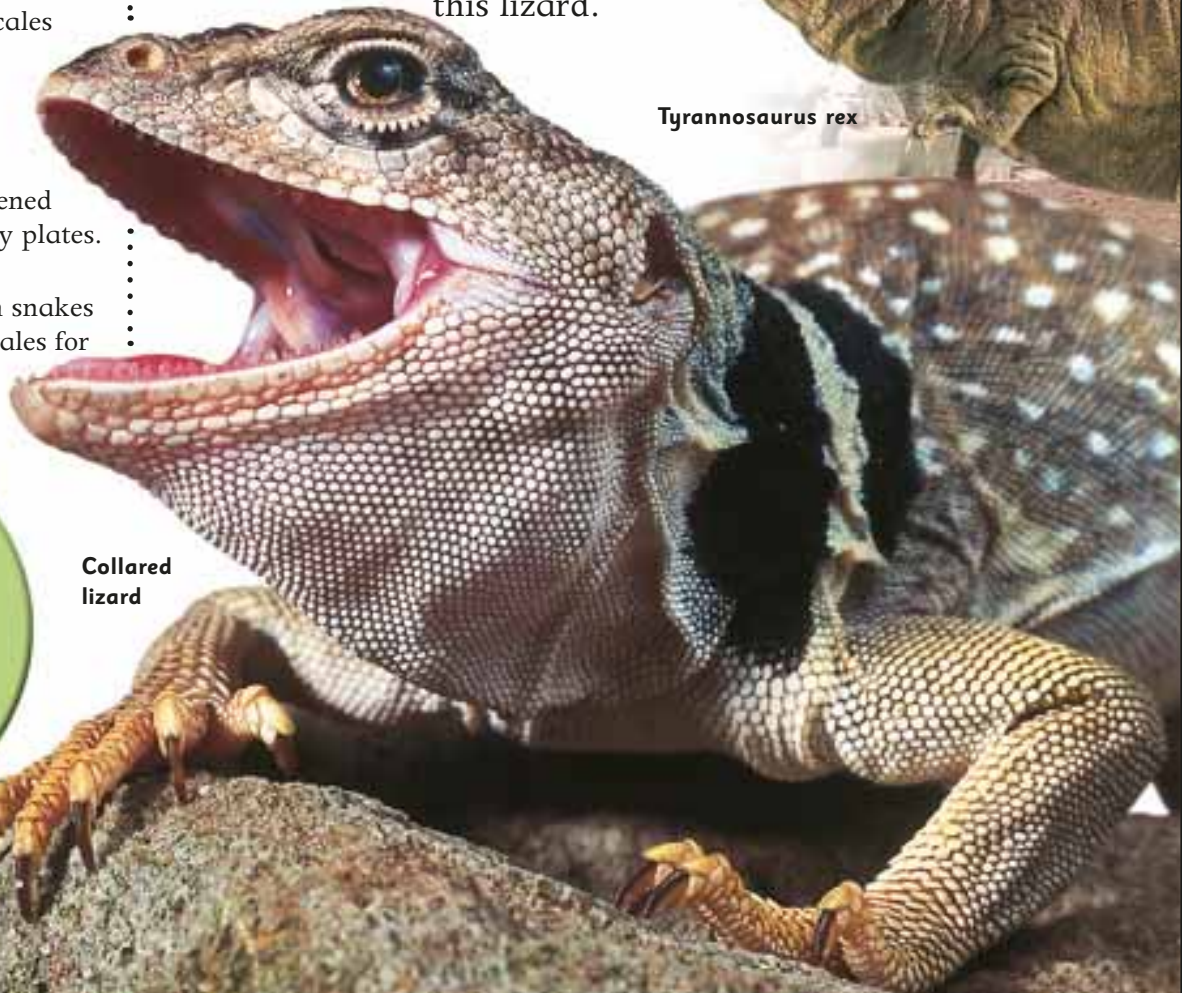
Snake: the skin on snakes has overlapping scales for extra protection.

Reptile relatives

The reptiles of today are the last living relatives of dinosaurs and look very similar to their ancient ancestors. You can see similarities between the *Tyrannosaurus rex* and this lizard.



Tyrannosaurus rex



Collared lizard

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